c. Endosperm

- This is the large central part of the kernel and constitutes 84-85 percent of the kernel.
- The endosperm consists mainly of starch and protein. But low in mineral matter, fibre, fat and vitamins.

d. Germ

- This is a small structure at the lower end of the kernel and is separated from the endosperm by the scutellum.
- It makes up 2-3 percent of the whole kernel.
- It is rich in protein, fat, vitamins and minerals.
- Germ serves as a store of nutrients for the seed during germination. During milling some of the germ is lost along with the bran and aleurone layer.

II. Types of Wheat

a. Hard Wheat: Hardness is related to the degree of adhesion between starch and protein. Hard wheat yields coarse flour and is a good source of gluten. It is used to make bread flour.

b. Soft Wheat: Soft wheat gives very fine flour and contains less amount of good quality protein. It is used for making cakes, cookies and pastries.

c. Strong Wheat: Strong wheat is used to make good quality bread because it produces large loaf volume, good crumb structure and product with good keeping qualities. It has a high protein content.

d. Weak Wheat: Low protein content in weak wheat produces only a small loaf with coarse crumb structure. The flour of weak wheat is good for biscuits and cakes.

III. Types of Wheat Flour

Some of the types of flours used for baking are as follows:

a. Bread Flour:

- It is milled from blends of hard wheat.
- The moisture content, protein content, and starch quality can be controlled.
- It is used mainly for making products leavened with yeast.

b. Soft Flour: It is used for making all types of high quality cakes and sponge cakes.

c. Self-Raising Flour:

- A mixture of wheat flour and sodium carbonate is known as self-raising flour.
- This flour is used for making puddings, cakes, pastries etc.

DO YOU KNOW?

Proofing -
It is the final rise of shaped bread dough before baking (Also called as proving or blooming)

d. All-Purpose Flour:

- It is made from a blend of hard and soft wheat and has a moderate protein content.
- It is suitable for use in the yeast and quick breads, biscuits, pastries and cakes.

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